



ASSEMBLY
Elections 08



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It's time for bruised egos and petty turf wars again as political parties finalise tickets for the six states slated to go to the polls this winter. The star campaigners, BJP's Narendra Modi and Congress scion Rahul Gandhi, have already hit the campaign trail. Local issues tend to dominate and usually have a decisive role, the politics of the Centre also comes into play as the BJP attacks the Congress on inflation and terrorism. All in all, it's a regular carnival out there.

MOUTH Shut



Some former chief ministers of Rajasthan sat through five years in the Opposition benches in the Assembly but forgot to ask a single question, though none forgot to claim the allowances. S.C. Mathur picked up Rs 20 lakh while Ashok Gehlot kept his mouth shut and was Rs 17 lakh richer.
by Rohit Parihar

3.69

lakh is the number of first-timers who will vote in the Assembly polls in Jammu and Kashmir.

PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

RAJE (LEFT) WITH
SINGH



RAJASTHAN

Friends in Need

The Rajput and Thakur lobbies in Rajasthan seem to have left their old rivalries behind. Or almost. Vasundhara Raje, aiming for a second consecutive chief ministerial term, was given her political baptism by Bhairon Singh Shekhawat and Jaswant Singh but the fallout didn't take long. A bitter battle followed, with Singh hosting lunches for the BJP dissidents that ended in a case against him for serving opium at a party he hosted. With elections looming, a patch-up looks likely. She has also been making overtures to Shekhawat, who is not the kind to be easily appeased. Miffed at being sidelined in the party's election process, he has been vocal in attacking corruption in the Government. If all three get the desired number of seats for their supporters, that will be the first sign of a total ceasefire.

by Rohit Parihar